

30 days without

Agent 001 spends a month away from Google, hunting down all the alternatives to Google

Insight

A look at AMD's Phenom 2, how it differs from its predecessor and how it compares to Intel's counterparts

Killer rigs

The right computer and components for your budget

N270, 16-GB SSD, 1 GB memory, VGA and HDMI outs, a few USB 2.0 ports, and support for Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. All this packed into a slick looking keyboard with the bonus of segregated keys, similar to something you would find on a Mac.

ASUS has seen success with its Eee PC series and now they hope to duplicate the same with their Eee Keyboards. But we feel that this might not be that great an idea. Sure the concept is good, but looking down at the keyboard while typing is bound to strain one's

paid a major retailer to delay the launch of their competitors' products.

The manufacturers that have been identified are Acer, Dell, HP, Lenovo, and NEC.

Microsoft just did a Wii

Most of the Wii enthusiasts out there love their console and love being able to physically take part in the games. The only drawback, some might feel here is holding that remote in their hands. Rumours abound that there is something

completely eliminate the use of the extra 'plastic wand' in the hand. The way they are going about it is through the use of a 3D camera which is supposed to give more accurate control of the games.

This new 3D camera will be revealed at E3 this year, it is rumoured. It is believed to work using a camera in tandem with IR sensors which will need to be placed around your TV set. Interestingly, even Sony is rumoured to be working on a motion controller. E3 2009 should be very interesting indeed.

Firefox to emulate multi process systems

When it comes to browsers, there is a lot of contention among users. Some give more importance to look and feel, while others prefer the ability to install extensions, and yet others go for simplicity and browsers light on resources. To each his own we say. But there is one factor that no discerning user will overlook – speed. Firefox already has a sizeable chunk of the world's browser market, but Chrome is steadily catching on. If we are to

go by reports that Chrome 2 is about 20 per cent faster than its earlier version, Firefox better do something to stay on in the race. Well, it did. Process

separation, which basically means dissociating interface from content processes was first introduced by Chrome and later adopted by IE8 is now being incorporated by Firefox. This makes the browser more stable and faster too. Still, version 3.5 of the browser which is in the pipeline for imminent release will not have this feature.

Apparently, a team within Mozilla is working on an

unnamed project which trying viable methods to split the main interface process from web content processes. This ensures that if a page crashes only the tab will go down, not the entire browser. Meanwhile v3.5 has speed improvements through the TraceMonkey Javascript engine and some other improvements such as bookmarks and history features as well as searches through the "Awesomebar".

Software piracy comes down in India

As unbelievable as the above headline looks, a report by BSA-IDC Global says that software piracy in India has dropped to 68 per cent. Still, the drop is only one percentage point from 69 per cent in the previous year. The monetary damage caused to companies such as Adobe, Microsoft and Autodesk comes up to a whopping \$2.7 billion. So how does this compare to the world numbers? We're among the 57 countries



where piracy has declined, however little the drop may be. About 16 countries of the 110 studied showed a rise in piracy numbers. The rise in these few countries accounted for the global piracy to go up to 41 per cent and worldwide losses to go up to \$53 billion.

Piracy not only has an effect on the companies that sell software, but also on the health of the economy at large. For instance, a report by IDC last year shows that reducing software piracy by ten percentage points over a four year period could generate an additional 43,000 new jobs, lead to \$3.1 billion in economic growth, and \$200 million in tax revenues for the country. The decline in piracy in the



neck. This is pure speculation, of course, we won't know what to expect until we get our hands on the unit, which should be soon.

Intel gets slapped with a huge fine

Intel has been hitting the news lately, some good and some bad. The European Commission just hit Intel with a fine of US \$1.45 billion for violating the EC Treaty and "abusing their power unethically between October 2002 and December 2007". AMD had already filed complaints along these lines with the EC in 2000, 2003 and 2006, which urged a further investigation into this issue.

A summary of the claims are as follows: Intel allegedly gave hidden rebates to computer manufacturers and encouraged them to only stock up on their x86 CPUs. They also allegedly

brewing inside Microsoft that aims to address this very issue. Microsoft is said to be developing an answer to the Wii for their Xbox 360 console. So what exactly are they developing? It's a new system that will allow you to control the game through whole body movements.

This step forward has definitely been undertaken to get the edge on the game console market as about 600,000 Nintendo Wii consoles were sold in the US during the month of March 2009; these numbers were higher than Microsoft and Sony sales for their consoles put together.

What Microsoft has cooking is different because they are working on a way to

